

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/8: Source-critical entry

CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE



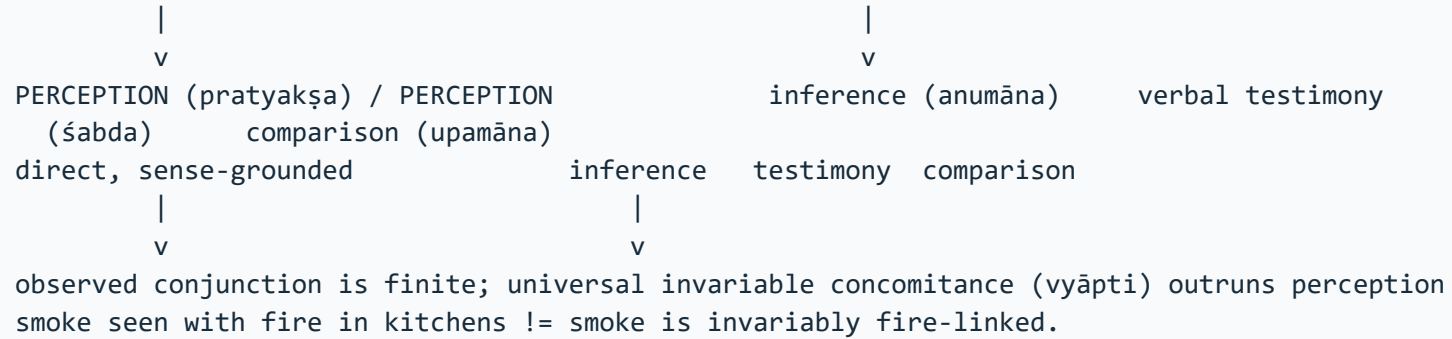
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RULE: distinguish attested thesis from hostile caricature
Lokāyata = this-worldly orientation; Cārvāka = materialist school label.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/8: Epistemic gate

VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMA)

REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/8: Inference controversy

CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti)

invariable concomitance (vyāpti) known by inference -> circularity | by perception -> incomplete survey

hidden condition (upādhi) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters

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NYĀYA REPLY: repeated agreement + absence of counter-instance + hypothetical reasoning (tarka)

agreement in presence (anvaya) (presence) + agreement in absence (vyatireka) (absence) ->

defeasible but rational invariable concomitance (vyāpti)

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CĀRVĀKA COUNTER-PRESSURE: practical expectation may work without certainty

SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE: arguing against inference already employs inference.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/8: Material ontology

ONLY THIS WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED

earth + water + fire + air -> organised living body -> consciousness

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consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance

analogy: fermentation ingredients -> intoxicating power not present separately

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SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda)

death -> elemental dissolution -> no surviving enduring self (ātman), rebirth or afterlife

QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/8: Transcendent denials

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT

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+-> no immortal soul -> no rebirth

+-> no action and moral consequence (karma) as supersensible moral force

+-> no heaven/hell -> no post-mortem reward or punishment

+-> no creator God -> world needs no transcendent planner

+-> no Vedic infallibility -> priestly testimony lacks intrinsic authority

RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/8: Ethics without caricature

PURUṢĀRTHA FILTER

dharmā: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command

liberation (mokṣa): rejected as liberation of a separable soul

material well-being (artha) + pleasure (kāma): intelligible goods within one embodied life

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prudent enjoyment != reckless indulgence

pleasure sought -> weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means

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EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness;

do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan “eat, drink and borrow.”

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/8: Comparative pressure map

ISSUE	CARVAKA	NYAYA	BUDDHISM
means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	perception only	four means of valid knowledge	
(pramāṇas)	perception + inference		
self	conscious body	enduring enduring self (ātman)	anātman stream
causation	observed sequence	realist relation	dependent origination
transcendent	denied	God, soul, action and moral consequence (karma)	action and
	moral consequence (karma) without creator		
liberation	death ends person	release (apavarga)	cessation of conditioned
suffering (nirvāṇa)			

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STRENGTH: anti-dogmatic evidential discipline

LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/8: PYQ answer rail

DEFINE source problem -> STATE perception thesis -> RECONSTRUCT inference attack

